

Unit Y307: Tudor Foreign Policy 1485–1603

This theme focuses on the aims, methods and results of Tudor foreign policy. Policy aims, achievements and failures in relation to Spain, France, Scotland and Burgundy (later the Netherlands) should be studied within a changing context. The impact of foreign policy on England should make clear links between the impact and the policies themselves. The strands

identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: Tudor Foreign Policy 1485–1603	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The aims and methods of Tudor foreign policy	The influence of financial, economic, religious, political personal and dynastic factors in shaping foreign policy; marriage, alliance, war and trade as instruments of foreign policy; changes in England's standing within Europe.
Scotland and France	Relations with Scotland and France; when and why they ceased to be England's traditional enemies; major turning points during the period; Henry VII and Ayton; Battle of Flodden; 'rough-wooing' and invasions under Henry VIII and Somerset; the Treaty of Edinburgh; the departure of the French; Henry VII and Etaples; Henry VIII's invasions; French threat under Somerset; loss of Calais; the Treaty of Blois.
Burgundy, the Netherlands and Spain	Their importance in Tudor foreign affairs including trade and trade embargoes, strategic importance and security; the reasons why relations with Spain changed from peace to war during the sixteenth century; Henry VII and Medina del Campo; Henry VIII and alliances against France; impact of the divorce; Mary Tudor and Philip's marriage; the impact of the Dutch Revolt; the Armada.
The impact of foreign relations on domestic developments in England	Effect on economic, financial, dynastic, political and religious affairs; impact on relations with Ireland.

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Depth studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
Henry VIII's foreign policy 1509–1520	The situation in 1509; Henry VII's legacy in foreign policy; Henry VIII's personal motives; Renaissance context; European rivals, inherited allies and enemies; objectives in France and Scotland; a comparison of the causes, campaigns and results of wars against Scotland and France; the Battle of Flodden (1513), the Battle of the Spurs (1513); Therouanne and Tournai; diplomacy with France and Spain; the Treaty of London (1518); the Field of the Cloth of Gold (1520); a comparative evaluation of the roles of Henry VIII, Wolsey and Catherine and the extent of their achievements.
The loss of Calais	The historical and strategic significance of Calais; its significance in the context of European affairs in 1557–1558; the condition of the garrison and costs in maintaining it; relations with France and Spain; reasons why England went to war with France in 1557; events leading to the loss of Calais in 1558; reasons why Calais was lost, including the Spanish marriage and the role of Philip II; the reactions of Mary I and of the English people at the time; the Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis (1559); French views on the recovery of Calais at the time; an evaluation of the positive and negative aspects of the loss of Calais.
The Armada	Long and short-term causes and motives of Spain's Enterprise of England; the Spanish fleet and its setbacks, including Drake's raid on Cadiz (1587), the death of Santa Cruz, Medina Sidonia's weaknesses as a commander of the Armada; Elizabeth's preparations; leadership of the English navy, its ships, supplies and morale; the Tilbury speech; Spanish ships, weaponry, crews, troops and priests on board; the course of events; advantages and disadvantages of England and Spain; reasons for the defeat of the Armada, reactions and propaganda in England, Spain and Europe; its significance for England and as a turning point in foreign policy.